

EVENT-DRIVEN THREAT HUNT

PRE-ORDERING A CRIME WAVE

The most anticipated game launch in history is still months away — and the fraud infrastructure is already built. We identified **140 domains** running GTA VI scams, **every one registered in 2026**, with **87% appearing in the last eight weeks**. We verified them this afternoon: **71 are serving live fraud right now**.

Source: Webamon passive web-scan data 140 confirmed domains 2,504-domain GTA surface
verified 2026-07-31

140

confirmed GTA VI fraud domains identified

100%

registered in 2026 — none are legacy squats

6×

growth in new GTA domains, January to June

71

serving live fraud when we checked today

01 THE BUILD-OUT IS HAPPENING NOW

The pages themselves advertise a **19 November 2026** release. The criminal supply chain is not waiting for it — it is provisioning ahead of demand, which is exactly when defenders

are least likely to be looking.

New GTA-themed domains observed per month

Across the full 2,504-domain GTA surface.



Confirmed fraud domains, by first appearance

140 confirmed-malicious set only.



122 of 140 (87%) first appeared in June and July. This is a deliberate ramp timed to the launch window, not background noise.

Every one of the 140 was registered in 2026. There is no long tail of dormant squats here — the entire estate is fresh, which means it was built specifically for this event and will be discarded after it.

02 FOUR FRAUD ARCHETYPES

The ecosystem is not malware. It is **money** — separating fans from payments, card details

and crypto ahead of a product that does not yet exist.

ARCHETYPE	MECHANISM	REPRESENTATIVE DOMAINS
Fake pre-order storefronts	Take payment for a game that cannot be delivered	gta6preordernow.com · dayonedropgames.com · gtavi-prevenda.shop · rockstarbr.store
Crypto / token scams	Presales and "meme coins" riding launch hype	gta6coin.fun · gtavimeme.vip · ross-drop.xyz · rockstarairdrop.org
Fake early access / beta	"Beta licence" or "early access" fees and data capture	gta6early.com · gtaplaynow.com · get4play.com · betag.online
Download / APK bait	Non-existent PC and Android builds	gta6apkdl.net · gta6download.net · gta6forpc.org

Rockstar's brand, worn directly

Pages serving the genuine title "*Grand Theft Auto VI - Rockstar Games*" on domains Rockstar does not own:

- rockztargames.com — homoglyph typosquat
- rstargames.com — consonant-skeleton abbreviation
- rockstargames-eua.shop, gta6-rockstargames.shop
- rockstargames.games / .blog / .money / .promo — TLD squatting on the exact brand
- rockstargames-playstation.com — two brands in one domain

Discount and scarcity engineering

The storefronts deploy classic conversion pressure:

- "30% OFF with Code FIRST30" — one template across gtapre.com, gtapresale.online, vicecity.space
- "GTAVI SOLD OUT — Pre-Order Info Hub" — manufactured scarcity
- "GTA VI × Solana — Pre-order with 25% Discount" — crypto payment, irreversible by design
- "Ships Day One", "Ultimate Edition", "Collector's Edition"

03 THE BRAZILIAN PRE-SALE MACHINE

The single most organised cluster is Portuguese-language, and it reveals something larger

than GTA.

One template, many shopfronts

Eleven domains serve a byte-similar page titled "GTA 6 - GRAND THEFT AUTO VI PRÉ VENDA MIDIA DIGITAL PARA PS5" — `zonadejogo.shop`, `vortexplay.store`, `playzonegamer.online`, `baraogames.store`, `vaultgames.online`, `preshopp.online`, `gamesnpc.com` and more.

A wider Portuguese *pré-venda* sweep returns **127 domains**.

The same crews sell whatever is hot

That *pré-venda* cluster is not GTA-specific. The same infrastructure and naming conventions also run:

Panini World Cup 2026 albums — `copadomundopanini.com`, `albumcopa2026.shop`

BTS concert tickets — `btsingresso.com`

CNH Social driving licences — the government programme documented in our public-sector research

This is a general-purpose Brazilian pre-sale fraud economy. GTA VI is simply the current highest-demand product passing through it.

Why that matters for prediction. Because the operators are event-agnostic, their next targets are forecastable: any product with an announced date, constrained supply and an impatient audience. The infrastructure is already in place before the announcement lands.

04 WHAT WE VERIFIED TODAY

Historic detections age badly. We actively probed all 140 domains on **2026-07-31 at 16:19 UTC** — DNS resolution, TCP, TLS handshake, then HTTP response.

Live status



100 of 140 have live hosting; 71 are serving GTA-branded fraud content at this moment. Only 16 have had DNS removed — the closest thing to a real takedown in this set.

Serving right now

DOMAIN	LIVE PAGE TITLE
<code>accessopregame.site</code>	Grand Theft Auto VI - Pré-venda
<code>dayonedropgames.com</code>	GTA 6 Pre-Order — PS5 & Xbox, Ships Day One
<code>gta6.website</code>	GTA VI Pre-Order Key Giveaway
<code>gta6early.com</code>	GTA 6 Early Access
<code>gta6coin.fun</code>	GTA VI — The OG GTA 6 Meme Coin on Solana
<code>gta6oficialbr.com</code>	Grand Theft Auto VI — Pré-venda Oficial
<code>gta6apkdl.net</code>	GTA 6 APK Download for Android, PC
<code>gamesrockstars.click</code>	Grand Theft Auto VI — Pré-venda

05 WHAT THIS IS NOT

Two expectations the data did not support. Both are worth stating, because acting on the wrong threat model wastes the window.

It is not a malware campaign

Across the entire GTA surface we found **zero** Telegram-bot exfiltration, **zero** Discord webhook exfiltration and **zero** paste-and-run / PowerShell lures.

Game-launch fraud is widely assumed to be an infostealer delivery problem. In this dataset it is overwhelmingly **payment and crypto fraud**. Controls aimed only at executable delivery will not engage.

It is not only about the game

The GTA brand is also being used as a **traffic lure for unlicensed gambling** — GTA369 (Thai slots), `gta-6-casino-game.app`, `lerockstarcasino.com` ("Rockstar Casino France").

This mirrors the neobank-brand abuse documented in our financial-services research: a trusted consumer brand borrowed to legitimise an unrelated regulated product.

RIGHTS HOLDERS & PLATFORMS

1. **Act before launch, not after.** 87% of this estate appeared in the last eight weeks — the takedown window is open now and closes when pre-orders convert.
2. **Register-and-monitor the obvious permutations** — `rockstargames.{tld}` is being squatted across `.games`, `.blog`, `.money` and `.promo`.
3. **Monitor homoglyph and skeleton variants**, not just exact strings — `rockztargames`, `rstargames`.

DETECTION TEAMS

1. **Hunt the page title, not just the domain.** The cloned "*Grand Theft Auto VI - Rockstar Games*" title appears on domains with no brand token at all.
2. **Cluster on templates.** One title string exposed eleven storefronts; one discount code (`FIRST30`) exposed three more.
3. **Re-verify liveness continuously.** 40 of 140 were already non-serving by the time we checked — a static IOC list decays within weeks.

CONSUMER PROTECTION

1. **Warn on the pre-order vector specifically** — "sold out", "day one", "% off" and crypto payment are the recurring conversion levers.
2. **Expect the same crews at the next event.** The Brazilian cluster already runs World Cup albums, concert tickets and government licences through identical infrastructure.